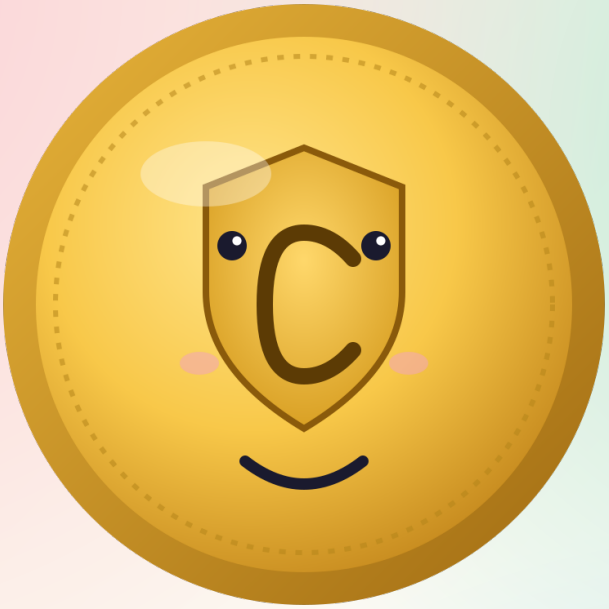
CASH TO COMPANY

K-12 CURRICULUM



GRADE 2

Student Activity Book

C A S H

Businesses solve problems

Sort, draw, count, and notice — together.

Grade 2 — Cash to Company: Student Activity Book

Hi, friend! I'm Cash.

This is your book for second grade. We are going to find problems. We are going to make ideas. We are going to ask classmates what they would change.

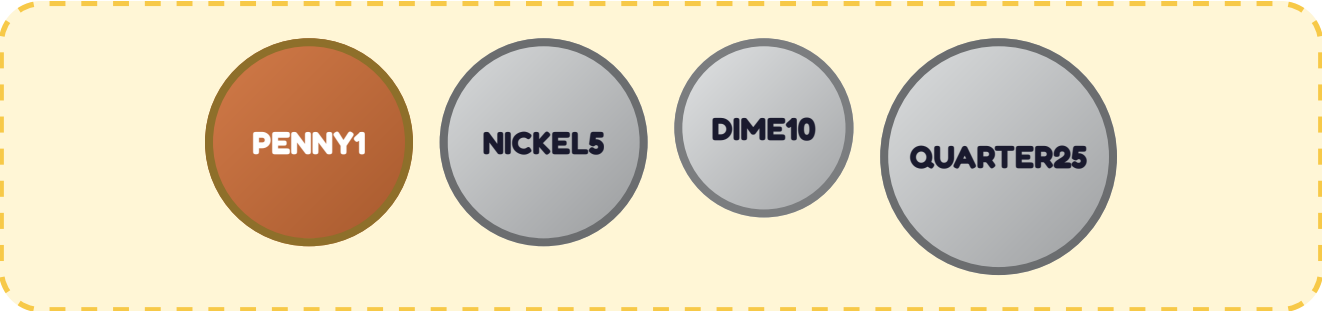
You will draw. You will write. You will circle. Some pages have lines for words. Some pages have big boxes for pictures. Both are okay.

[VISUAL — front cover] Cash, the coin-shaped mascot, holds a clipboard with three checkboxes. Behind Cash: a school hallway. A child notices a stack of mismatched mittens. Another child notices a long lunch line. A third child draws a sign. The title reads "MY PROBLEM-AND-IDEA BOOK."

How to use this book

- A grown-up or your teacher reads any words that are hard. Most weeks, you can read them yourself by spring.
- Take your time. This book is yours.
- It is okay to be wrong. Trying is the deal.
- It is okay to fix what you wrote. We call that **revising**.

[VISUAL — full page] A child at a desk. Cash sits next to them, watching. Both have pencils. The child is drawing. A scribbly first try sits next to a cleaner second try.



Cash says: Look first. Then draw. Then ask a friend.

Unit 1 — Problems we see

[VISUAL — unit opener] A class hallway with a big bulletin board. Sticky notes show problems: "the line is too long," "lost mittens," "the pencil sharpener jams." Cash points at the wall.

Cash says: A problem is a thing that bothers us. A problem is a thing a helper can fix.

Activity 1.1 — A problem I see

[VISUAL — full page] A blank rectangle in the middle of the page. Around the rectangle: small drawings of a stuck pencil sharpener, a lost mitten, a long line, a missing playground ball, a spilled juice.

Draw or write one problem you see in our school. Inside the rectangle.

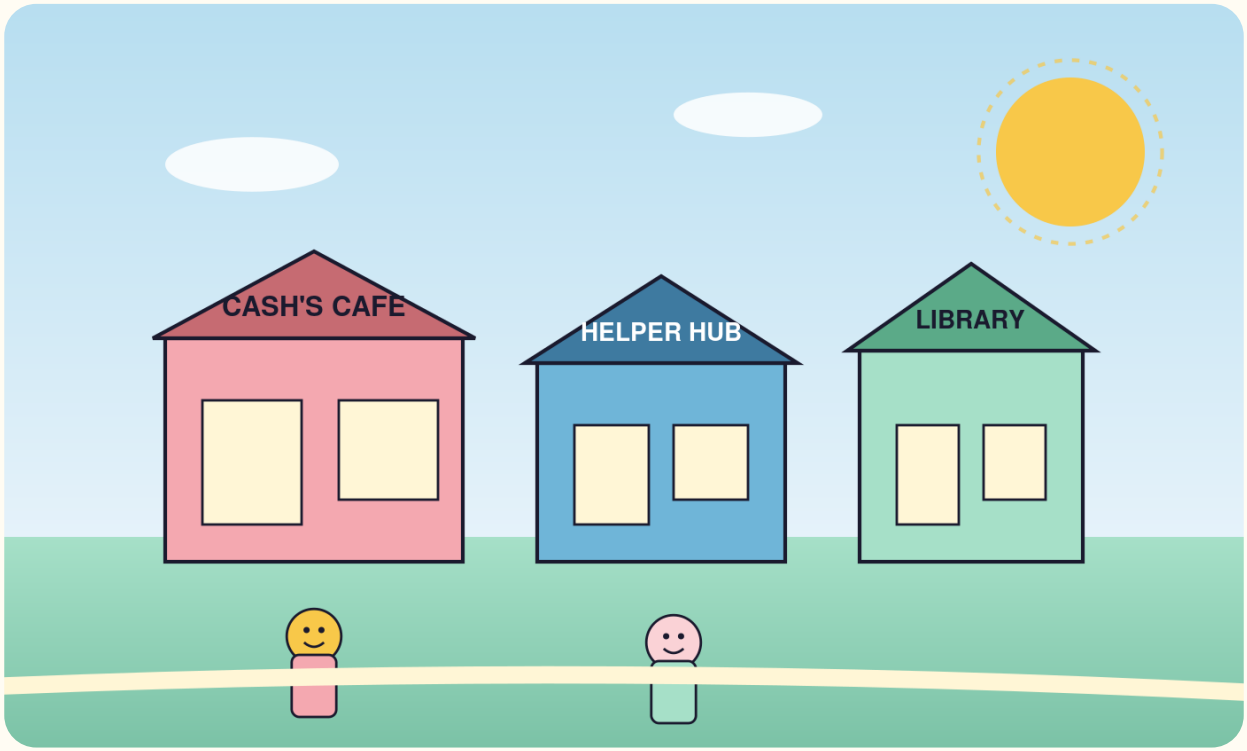
[VISUAL — bottom of page] Cash with a small notepad.

Cash says: Don't make it up. Look first.

Tell a partner: Where did you see this problem? Who has the problem?

Activity 1.2 — Match the problem to the helper

[VISUAL — left column: 5 problems with small pictures] (1) spilled juice, (2) lost mitten, (3) tired feet at recess, (4) empty stomach, (5) hair too long. [VISUAL — right column: 5 helpers with small pictures] (1) janitor with a mop, (2) mitten store, (3) shoe store, (4) snack stand, (5) hair salon.



Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

Draw a line from each problem to the helper that fixes it.

Tell a partner: Pick one match. Why is the helper a good fix?

Activity 1.3 — Two helpers for one problem

[VISUAL — top of page] A picture of a long lunch line.

Sometimes a problem has more than one helper. Write or draw two helpers for the long lunch line.

Helper 1: _____ Helper 2: _____

[VISUAL — bottom of page] Cash holding up two fingers, smiling.

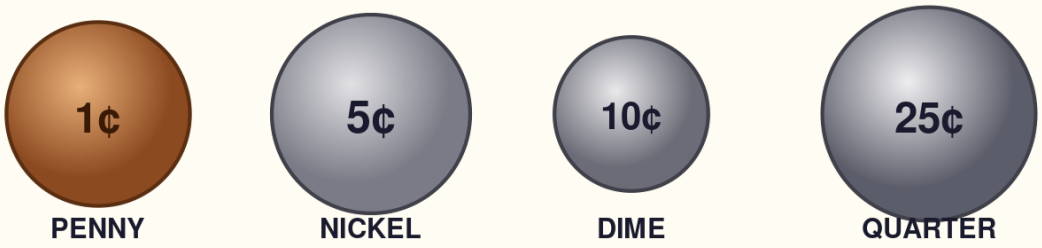
Cash says: Two ideas are better than one.

CASH SAYS

Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.

Activity 1.4 — My first Problem → Idea card

[VISUAL — full page, an oversized index-card outline divided in half] Top half: a box labeled PROBLEM. Bottom half: a box labeled IDEA. Both have a few lines and a small drawing area.



Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

PROBLEM: _____ (Draw a small picture of the problem in the corner of this box.)

IDEA: _____ (Draw a small picture of the idea in the corner of this box.)

My name: _____

[VISUAL — bottom of page] Cash, with two thumbs up.

Cash says: This is your first try. We will make it better later.

Activity 1.4b — Three problems near me

PICTURE

Look around our room or our hallway right now. Find three problems. Draw one in each box.

Box 1: ____ Box 2: ____ Box 3: _____

[VISUAL — bottom of page] Cash, with three small stickies on a clipboard.

Cash says: Real problems are everywhere. We just have to look.

Tell a partner: Which one is the biggest? Which one is the smallest? Which one would be hardest to fix?

Activity 1.5 — Was it a problem? Was it a helper?

PICTURE

Scene A: A child trips on a backpack in the hallway. **Scene B:** A custodian moves the backpack to a hook. **Scene C:** Now another child walks the hallway with no trip.

Circle the **problem.** Underline the **helper.** Star the **fix.**

Tell a partner: What did the helper do? For who?

Unit 2 — Coins and change

[VISUAL — unit opener] A pretend store counter. A pretzel sits on a plate with a price tag — 67¢. Beside it: a paper dollar. Below: 1 quarter, 1 nickel, 3 pennies — labeled "CHANGE." Cash points at the change.

Cash says: A dollar is one hundred cents. The change is what comes back.

Activity 2.1 — Coin chart

[VISUAL — full page] A clean chart. Penny — 1 dot. Nickel — 5 dots. Dime — 10 dots. Quarter — 25 dots. Dollar — 100 dots in a 10x10 grid.

Trace each number. Say each name out loud.

Penny: 1. Nickel: 5. Dime: 10. Quarter: 25. Dollar: 100.

[VISUAL — corner] Cash holding all five.

Cash says: Same as last year, plus one more. The dollar is new.

Activity 2.2 — Make change (the easy ones)

PICTURE

Row 1. Price: 75¢. Change: **_¢. Coins:** quarter(s). **Row 2.** Price: 50¢. Change: **_¢. Coins:** quarter(s) and **_ quarter(s). (Or two quarters.)**

Row 3. Price: 25¢. Change: ¢. Coins: **_ quarter(s) and** quarter(s) and ____ quarter(s). (Three quarters.)

Tell a partner: Which one had the most change?

CASH SAYS

What comes first? What comes next?

Activity 2.3 — Make change (the trickier ones)

PICTURE

Row 1. A pretzel. Price: 60¢. Change from a dollar: **_¢. Draw the coins. Row 2. A sticker. Price: 33¢. Change from a dollar:** _¢. Draw the coins. **Row 3.** A pencil. Price: 10¢. Change from a dollar: ____¢. Draw the coins.

Tell a partner: Did you use a quarter? A dime? Why that coin?

[VISUAL — bottom corner] Cash with a small chart on the wall in the background.

Cash says: Use the chart if you forget. The chart is a helper too.

Activity 2.4 — Setup checklist

PICTURE

For our Class Market, follow the steps. Check each one off.

- [ ] **Step 1:** sign up
- [ ] **Step 2:** goods out
- [ ] **Step 3:** prices on
- [ ] **Step 4:** coins in the drawer
- [ ] **Step 5:** ready to open

[VISUAL — bottom] Cash holding a chime, ready to ring it.

Cash says: When all the boxes are checked, you ring the bell. The store is open.

Activity 2.5 — At the Class Market

[VISUAL — full page coloring scene] Two children at a market stall. One wears an apron. The other holds a paper dollar. A small sign says "PRETZELS — 50¢." A jar of coins sits on the counter.

Color the picture.

Tell a partner: Who is the shopkeeper? Who is the customer? How much change comes back?

Unit 3 — Signs, teams, and fair play

[VISUAL — unit opener] Four signs hang in a row: OPEN, LINE FORMS HERE, TODAY'S SPECIAL, CLOSED. Below: a classroom skit with three labeled children — BOSS, WORKER, CUSTOMER.

Cash says: Signs help customers. Teams have parts. Fair is fair.

Activity 3.1 — Draw a helpful sign

[VISUAL — top of page] Three example signs from real life: a coffee shop "OPEN," a grocery line tape, a "Today's Special" chalkboard.

PICTURE

Draw a sign for any business you can think of. Make it big. Make it clear.

My business: ____ My sign says: ____

Tell a partner: Why does this sign help the customer?

CASH SAYS

Tell me what they said with their words.

Activity 3.2 — Three jobs on a team

PICTURE

In each box, draw the helper.

Box 1: BOSS. Drawing: **_. The boss says: "Today we sell ___ for ___ cents." Box 2: WORKER. Drawing: . The worker says: "Yes, here's a ___." Box 3: CUSTOMER. Drawing:** __. The customer says: "Please, may I have a ___?"

[VISUAL — bottom] Cash with three lanyards on a hook.

Cash says: Boss decides. Worker does. Customer buys. All three matter.

Activity 3.3 — Fair or not fair?

PICTURE

Story A. Maya runs a lemonade stand. She fills every cup the same way. She charges 25¢ each.

Was that fair to the customer? **YES / NO.** Why? ___

Story B. Jonas runs a cookie stand. He gives his friend two cookies. He gives his neighbor one cookie. Same price.

Was that fair to the customer? **YES / NO.** Why? ___

Story C. Priya says her bracelets are silver. They are plastic painted silver.

Was that fair to the customer? **YES / NO.** Why? ___

[VISUAL — bottom] Cash with a small sign that reads "HONEST."

Cash says: Fair means honest. Fair means the same for everybody. No tricks.

Activity 3.4 — Fix the unfair story

PICTURE

How could Jonas make his cookie stand fair?

Write or draw your fix: _____

Tell a partner: Would you buy from Jonas now? Why or why not?

Unit 4 — The Solve-It Fair

[VISUAL — unit opener] A classroom set up like a fair. Children stand at small booths. Each has a Problem → Idea card. A grown-up reads

one. Cash holds a microphone. A sign overhead reads "SOLVE-IT FAIR."

Cash says: This is the year's big day. We show our ideas. We say what we changed.

Activity 4.1 — My new Problem → Idea card

[VISUAL — full page, oversized index-card outline divided in half] Top: PROBLEM box. Bottom: IDEA box. A small "drawing corner" on each.

This is your **second** Problem → Idea card. Use what you learned this year.

PROBLEM: _____ (Draw a small picture in the corner.)

IDEA: _____ (Draw a small picture in the corner.)

My name: _____

[VISUAL — bottom corner] Cash holds the first card from Unit 1 and points at this new card. A speech bubble says "BETTER!"

Cash says: Compare. Did your idea get sharper? Did your problem get clearer?

Activity 4.2 — "What would you change?"

[VISUAL — top: two children looking at a card together] One child shows the card. The other points and says: "What would you change?"

Show your card to a classmate. Ask the question. Listen.

They said: _____ (Write what your classmate said. Or draw a picture of it.)

My partner's name: _____

[VISUAL — bottom] Cash with a clipboard, taking notes.

Cash says: Listen with your ears. Don't argue. Just write.

CASH SAYS

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

Activity 4.3 — Two more partners

PICTURE

Find two more classmates. Ask the question. Listen.

Partner 2 said: _____ Partner 3 said: _____

Tell yourself: Which idea will I try? Why?

I will try: _____ **Because: _____**

Activity 4.4 — Fair check on my own idea

PICTURE

Use the fairness rule on your own idea.

- [ ] My idea is honest. (No tricks.)

- [ ] My idea would be the same for every customer.
- [ ] If my customer asked questions, my answers would be true.

If any box is empty, what would I change?

[VISUAL — bottom] Cash holding a small "FAIR" card.

Cash says: Honest first. Fix the trick before someone notices.

Activity 4.5 — Solve-It Fair script

PICTURE

When a grown-up comes to my booth, I will say:

"Hi. My problem is **_. My idea is _**. My classmate **_ said I should change _**. I think I will try **_ because _**."

Practice once with a partner. Then practice once with the teacher.

Tell a partner: What part is the hardest to remember?

Activity 4.6 — Family Visit Day picture

[VISUAL — full page, a blank box with a name line at the bottom]
Cash, in the corner, waves with both hands.

Draw a picture of you and your grown-up at the Solve-It Fair.

My name: _____

Cash says: I am proud of you. You saw a problem. You had an idea. You asked. You shared. That is the work.

My Cash Words (Word Wall — last page)

PICTURE

- **problem** — (a stuck pencil sharpener)
- **idea** — (a lightbulb)
- **business** — (a small storefront)
- **customer** — (a person with a coin)

- **boss** — (a person with a clipboard)
- **worker** — (a person with an apron)
- **change** — (coins coming back from a hand)
- **dollar** — (a paper bill)
- **sign** — (a board on a stick)
- **checklist** — (a clipboard with checkmarks)
- **fair** — (two equal cookies)
- **revise** — (an arrow looping back)
- **team** — (three people side by side)
- **share** — (two hands open)

[VISUAL — bottom corner] Cash holding a paper that says "GOOD JOB NOTICING."

Cash says: This was a big year. You noticed problems. You made ideas. You asked classmates. You changed your work. You shared. Notice, notice, notice — and now, ask, ask, ask. See you in third grade.

A short letter to my next year's teacher

PICTURE

Fill in for your future teacher to read.

One thing I learned this year: ____ One problem I still want to solve: ___ One thing about being a customer that surprised me: __ One thing about being a worker that surprised me: _____

[VISUAL — bottom] Cash holding a small letter and a stamp.

Cash says: Your next teacher wants to know what you learned. Tell them. They will be glad.

A Cash check-in (just for you)

[VISUAL — full page] Cash with a small clipboard, looking at the reader. A row of five smiley/neutral/frowny faces at the bottom.

This page is just for you. Nobody is grading it.

One problem I am proud of finding this year: _____

One idea I had that I would still try if I had time: _____

One thing my classmates said that helped me the most: _____

The hardest part of second grade for me was: _____

Circle a face for how you feel about the year: 😄 (great) — 🙂 (good) — 😐 (okay) — 😕 (hard) — 😢 (sad)

[VISUAL — bottom corner] Cash with a small heart bubble.

Cash says: All the answers are okay. I read them all. Notice, notice, notice.

CASH

Which people, and how do you know?

Senior expert upgrade pack — Deliberate practice (Grade 2)

Practice A — Five problems on a walk

On your way home from school today, write down five problems you see. Don't fix them yet. Just notice.

1.
2.
3.

4.

5.

Circle the one that bugged you the most.

Practice B — One problem, three ideas

Pick the circled problem. Write three different ideas a business could try.

Idea 1	Idea 2	Idea 3

Which idea sounds most real-able? Underline it. Why? ____

Practice C — Make change from $1.00

Practice making change. For each price, write the change:

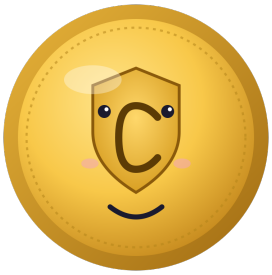
Item costs	Change from $1
67¢	
30¢	
95¢	
12¢	
50¢	
88¢	

(Tip: count up from the price. $0.67 + 33¢ = $1.00.)

Practice D — Fair-to-the-customer check

Read each. Circle Fair or Not Fair, and write one reason.

1. The store charged the same price as on the sign. **Fair / Not Fair** because ____
2. The store said "free toy with purchase" but ran out of toys. **Fair / Not Fair** because ____
3. The cashier gave the right change but no smile. **Fair / Not Fair** because ____
4. The store said "open" but the door was locked. **Fair / Not Fair** because ____



Which people, and how do you know?

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade 2